



OFFICIAL RULEBOOK

Global conquest in the Flash Gordon universe — a trick-taking card game where every hand changes the rules

3–6

PLAYERS

90

MINUTES

14+

AGE

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OVERVIEW

Mongo is a trick-taking card game of planetary conquest set in the public-domain Flash Gordon universe. Three to six players vie for control of the planet Mongo, forging alliances, commanding armies, and exploiting the shifting political landscape of Ming’s crumbling empire.

What makes Mongo unique is its evolving ruleset: every hand you win doesn’t just score points — it changes the rules for the next hand. Conquer the Hawk Men’s sky city and aerial attacks become cheaper. Seize the ice kingdom of Frigia and defensive plays gain new power. The game you’re playing in round five bears little resemblance to the game you started in round one.

The result is a strategic card game where long-term planning matters as much as tactical play, and where no two sessions unfold the same way.

What's in the Box

COMPONENTS

Content in development — rules pending playtest.

ITEM	QTY	NOTES
Conquest Cards	108	Six suits representing Mongo’s kingdoms.
Rule Modifier Tiles	24	Applied when kingdoms are conquered.
Territory Board	1	Map of Mongo divided into six regions.
Faction Tokens	36	6 per player in distinct colours.
Alliance Markers	12	Used to track temporary alliances.
Score Track	1	Perimeter scoring for conquest points.
Rulebook	1	This document.

Preparing to Play

SETUP

Content in development — rules pending playtest.

- 1 Place the Territory Board in the centre of the table.
- 2 Shuffle the Conquest Cards and deal a starting hand to each player.
- 3 Place Rule Modifier Tiles face-down on their corresponding territories.
- 4 Each player chooses a faction and places their starting tokens.
- 5 Determine first player by the method described in the advanced rules.

Playing the Game

GAMEPLAY

TURN STRUCTURE

Content in development — rules pending playtest.

Each round consists of a series of tricks. On your turn within a trick:

- 1 **Play a card** from your hand following the lead suit or play a trump.
- 2 **Resolve the trick** — highest card in the lead suit (or highest trump) wins.
- 3 **Claim territory** — the trick winner may place or move a faction token.
- 4 **Apply modifiers** — if a territory is newly conquered, reveal and apply its Rule Modifier Tile.

TRICKS AND SUITS

Content in development — rules pending playtest.

The six suits represent the kingdoms of Mongo. Each suit has unique properties that interact with the rule modifier system.

ALLIANCES

Content in development — rules pending playtest.

Players may form temporary alliances during a round. Allied players gain shared benefits but must eventually betray each other to win.

Endgame

WINNING

Content in development — rules pending playtest.

The game ends when one player controls a majority of Mongo's territories, or when the Conquest Card deck is exhausted. Victory is determined by conquest points earned through territory control, completed alliances, and rule modifier bonuses.

Optional Complexity

ADVANCED RULES

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Advanced rules introduce additional mechanics for experienced players, including:

- ♦ **Ming's Decree** — A global event system that disrupts all players simultaneously.
- ♦ **Technology Tracks** — Long-term investments that pay off in later rounds.
- ♦ **Betrayal Timing** — Precise rules for when alliances can be broken for maximum effect.

Common Questions

FAQ

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Q: Can I play with fewer than 3 players? A: Mongo requires a minimum of 3 players for the alliance system to function. There is no 2-player variant.

Q: How long does a typical game last? A: Approximately 90 minutes for experienced players. First games may run longer as players discover how rule modifiers interact.

Q: Is knowledge of Flash Gordon required? A: Not at all. The theme is flavour — no prior knowledge of the source material is needed to play.



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